

ABOUT SHIRLEY'S

Named after Shirley. Built for the person behind the till.

Shirley's Wellbeing CIC is a community interest company for retail workers dealing with the aftermath of abuse, threats and violence at work.

[Photo: Denise Sutherland, founder — a real portrait, natural light]

Our story

Shirley was Denise Sutherland's mother. Her way of seeing the person first, and of noticing when someone was struggling, is the heart of the organisation that carries her name.

Denise spent more than 20 years in retail, including in management. She knows what it's like to be the one called to the front when a customer turns, and the one expected to hold the team together afterwards. Alongside retail she brings experience in fitness, counselling training and supporting people through domestic violence.

That combination shaped one question: **what happens to the person afterwards?** Too often, the honest answer is nothing.

What we are, and what we're not

WE ARE

- Group support, movement and conversation for people affected by violence and abuse at work

WE'RE NOT

- An emergency or crisis service
- Therapy or treatment for trauma

- A route to specialist help when someone needs more, including NHS Talking Therapies and their GP
- Support for managers and supervisors, who are often both targets and the people expected to help
- A partner to employers, alongside the support they already offer

- Investigators. We don't look into incidents or decide who was to blame
- Going to ask you to relive what happened

How we work

We're starting small and local, in Solihull and the West Midlands, so we can get it right before we grow.

- 01 Grounded in evidence.** Our programmes follow what the research says helps after a difficult experience, and avoid what can make things worse.
- 02 Built with retail workers.** Our 2026 survey of local retail staff shaped what we offer, and their feedback keeps shaping it.
- 03 Measured honestly.** We track wellbeing, confidence and help-seeking before and after, and we'll publish what we find.
- 04 Safe by design.** You choose how much to share, you can opt out at any point, and we'll always tell you what happens next.

Our values

People

See the person first.

Trust

Earn it. Build it. Protect it.

Respect

For yourself. For others.

Community

Bringing people together.

Talk to us

Call, text or email. You don't need to explain why you're getting in touch.

07913 204385

[Hello@ShirleyswellbeingCIC.co.uk](mailto>Hello@ShirleyswellbeingCIC.co.uk)

Shirley's is not an emergency service

In immediate danger: **999**

Urgent but not an emergency: **NHS 111**

Someone to talk to, any time: **Samaritans 116 123**

Retail Trust helpline: **[number to confirm]**